6. The Wild Boars eventually found themselves **marooned** on a small rocky shelf about 4 km from the cave entrance, past a dry point known as Pattaya Beach which by now was flooded. Surrounded by darkness, the boys lost all sense of time. But they were determined to survive. They used rocks to dig deeper into the shelf to create a **cavern** where they could huddle together and keep warm. Coach Aken, a former monk, taught the boys meditation techniques to help them stay calm and use as little air as possible and told them to lie still to conserve their strength. They had no food but they had water in the form of moisture dripping from the caves' walls. They had the right conditions to survive at least for a little while. And most importantly the team had the support of each other.

7. Outside the cave, a full blown rescue operation was quickly unfolding. The Thai Navy Seals, the National Police, other rescue teams and local volunteers pitched in.

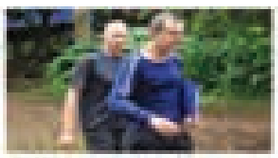
8. Exploring the cave was a challenge. Weather was merciless and the heavy rainfall and flooding chambers hindered the rescuers.

9. Engineers desperately tried to pump water out of the cave – but struggled initially.

10. At the start no one had any idea what to do. They even tried drilling into the mountain side and used **drones** with thermal sensors to locate the boys.

11. Outside the cave, the boys' worried families offered prayers for their lives. The group gradually expanded to include teachers, administrators, classmates and villagers who rallied together, donating money and hundreds of packages of food to the relatives of the boys and their coach. A sense of community soon began to spread, volunteers from other parts of Thailand flew in, while social media lit up with expressions of love and support.

12. International cave divers from UK, USA, Belgium, Australia, Scandinavia and many other countries arrived by Thursday, 28th June. Over the next few days, the divers faced a constant battle with the elements. Two British divers John Volanthen and Rick Stanton had been braving Than Luang's narrow, murky passage ways for several days laying out guide ropes and by 2nd July Monday, the lost Wild Boars and their coach had been found. The two divers spent some time trying to boost their morale. They left lights, and promised to return with food. The parents of the boys were **ecstatic** to know that their children had miraculously survived.



13. After nine days, the group received medicated liquid food and mineral water with vitamins.

12th Communicative English Book.indb 116 02/02/19 5:09 PM